PREMIER LEAGUE 2026/27 · MATCHWEEK 1

Fulham v Chelsea

Craven Cottage, London · August 24, 2026 (Monday) · Kickoff 2:00 PM Central / 20:00 UK

PROJECTED XI — NOT CONFIRMED

NO.	PLAYER / POSITION	FROM	AT CHELSEA	PREVIOUSLY	PLAYING STYLE	KEY STATS
1 GK	**Robert Sánchez** GOALKEEPER	Spain	Since Aug 2023 — 4th season	Brighton; Rochdale & Forest Green (loans); Levante academy	At 6 ft 5 in he fills the goal and is a genuinely good shot-stopper on his day, but he is the squad's most argued-over starter after repeated errors…	2025–26, CHELSEA 9 clean sheets, 32 apps
24 RCB	**Reece James** RIGHT CENTRE-BACK · CAPTAIN	England	Academy from 2005; senior squad since 2019 — 8th…	Chelsea academy; Wigan Athletic (loan, 2018/19)	Club captain.	2025–26, CHELSEA 27 apps, 4 assists
5 CB	**Maxence Lacroix** CENTRE-BACK	France	July 2026, about £52m ($69m) from Crystal Palace	Crystal Palace; Wolfsburg; Sochaux	Reportedly the fastest centre-back in the Premier League by top speed.	2025–26, CRYSTAL PALACE 35 apps (all starts), 11 clean sheets
6 LCB	**Levi Colwill** LEFT CENTRE-BACK	England	Academy from 2012; first team since 2023 — 4th senior…	Chelsea academy; Huddersfield Town & Brighton (loans)	Left-footed, unflustered, progresses the ball through the left channel rather than sideways around it.	2025–26, CHELSEA — ACL RECOVERY 4 apps
7 RWB	**Pedro Neto** WINGER	Portugal	Since July 2024, about £54m from Wolves	Wolverhampton Wanderers; Lazio; Braga academy	Direct, one-v-one dribbler who attacks the byline and cuts back.	2025–26, CHELSEA 5 goals, 6 assists
25 CM	**Moisés Caicedo** CENTRAL MIDFIELD	Ecuador	Since Aug 2023, £100m plus add-ons — 4th season	Brighton; Beerschot (loan); Independiente del Valle	The engine.	2025–26, CHELSEA 84 tackles, 33 apps
8 CM	**Enzo Fernández** CENTRAL MIDFIELD	Argentina	Since Jan 2023, £106.8m — 4th full season	Benfica; River Plate; Defensa y Justicia (loan)	Deep-lying playmaker with the longest, most accurate passing range at the club.	2025–26, CHELSEA 10 goals, 4 assists
2 LWB	**Marco Palestra** RIGHT WING-BACK	Italy	July 2026, roughly £43–50m from Atalanta — contract to…	Atalanta; Cagliari (loan, 2025/26)	A lung-busting, up-and-down right wing-back with enormous repeat-sprint volume.	2025–26, CAGLIARI (LOAN) 37 Serie A apps, 4 assists
10 AM	**Cole Palmer** ATTACKING MIDFIELD	England	Since Sept 2023, £40m — 4th season	Manchester City (academy and first team)	Left-footed, drifts inside from the right, arrives late into the box, ice-cold from the penalty spot.	2025–26, CHELSEA 10 goals, 1 assist
17 AM	**Morgan Rogers** ATTACKING MIDFIELD	England	July 2026, £117m ($157m) from Aston Villa — club record…	Aston Villa; Middlesbrough; Manchester City academy; loans…	Powerful, low-slung ball carrier who takes possession on the half-turn and drives straight at defenders, and presses like a midfielder.	2025–26, ASTON VILLA 10 goals, 6 assists
9 ST	**João Pedro** CENTRE-FORWARD	Brazil	Since July 2025, £55m plus £5m	Brighton; Watford; Fluminense	Mobile, link-heavy forward rather than a target man: drops between the lines, spins in behind, presses from the front.	2025–26, CHELSEA 15 goals, 5 assists

Projection only — the official XI is published 60–75 minutes before kickoff. Last updated August 22, 2026. chelsea-fc-2026-27.netlify.app